🌈 Wellness: Reading

Health · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Wellness module (Dimensions of Wellness, Sleep, Self-Awareness, Decision-Making, SMART Goal, Financial Wellness)

Name: _____

The Dimensions of Wellness

Wellness is more than not being sick. It is the active process of taking care of every part of your health. Mr. Finstuen's class uses eight dimensions: physical, emotional, social, intellectual, occupational, environmental, spiritual and financial. The dimensions are connected, so a change in one affects the others.

All information gets into the brain through our senses: sight, hearing, smell, touch and taste. When you trail run, for example, you might smell leaves, hear birds and feel rocks under your feet. Noticing your senses helps you understand how an activity affects you.

Sleep is one of the most powerful tools for physical and emotional wellness. During sleep the brain stores memories, and the body repairs itself and fights illness. Teens need about 8 to 10 hours each night, but many people get 6 hours or less. Too little sleep is linked to poor mood, anxiety and disease.

We make many decisions every day. Everyday decisions have small effects. Impulsive decisions are made without thinking and can lead to harm, especially under stress. Responsible decisions use a model such as DECIDE: Define the decision, Explore your options, Consider the consequences, Identify your values, Decide and act, and Evaluate the results.

Goals help us grow in a dimension where we are weaker. A SMART goal is Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant and Timely. Financial wellness is part of this too: a budget pays for needs before wants, and risky money choices can leave a person without enough to make it to the end of the month.

Check your reading

1. Why are the eight dimensions described as connected?

2. Name two things the body or brain does during sleep.

3. How is a responsible decision different from an impulsive one?